MIL-B-50485A(AR)
30 JUNE 1981
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-50485(MU)
12 December 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BANDOLEER ASSEMBLY
FOR
CARTRIDGE, 40MM, M397, M397E1 and M433

This specification is approved for use by the U.S. Army Armament Research and Development Command and is available for use by all Department and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of bandoleer designated as Bandoleer Assembly, for Cartridge, 40MM, M397, M397E1 and M433

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-W-530	-	Webbing, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors
MIL-P-22748	-	Plastic, Polyethylene and Copolymers, High Density Molding and Extrusion Material
MIL-A-48078	-	Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions, General Specification For

FSC: 1310

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, Attn. DRDAR-QA, Dover, New Jersey 07801 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-141	-	Paint, Varnish, Lacquer, and Related Materials; Methods of Inspection, Sampling and Testing
FED-STD-595	-	Colors

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-1169	-	Packaging, Packing and Marking for Shipment for Inert Ammunition Components
MIL-STD-1188	-	Commerical Packaging of Supplies and Equipment

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT COMMAND

8882364	-	Bandoleer for Cartridge, 40MM, M397, M397E1 and M433

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

D1505-57T	-	Measurement of Density of Plastic by the Density Grandient Technique
D1238-57T	-	Measuring Flow Rates Of Thermoplastics by Extrusion Plastometer

(Application for copies should be addressed to: American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103)

3. REQUIREMENTS

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3.1 Material. Materials shall be in accordance with the applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Bandoleer. The bandoleer shall comply with all requirements specified on Drawing (Dwg.) 8882364, all associated drawings, and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Density. The density of the plastic parts shall be 0.948 to 0.952 grams per cubic centimeters.

3.4 Melt index. The melt index of the plastic parts shall be 2.0 to 4.0 gram/10 minutes, maximum.

3.5 Color. The color of the plastic parts shall be green, Number 34087, in accordance with Federal Standard FED-STD-595 and shall resist fading due to untra-violet.

3.6 Cracks. The body-flap assembly shall be free of cracks.

3.7 Functioning

3.7.1 At minus sixty-five degrees Fahrenheit (-65°F). Plastic parts shall not deform, shrink, or otherwise impair removal of the cartridge from the body, nor shall the flap closure on the body shrink to such a degree that release of the flap by normal hand, pressure cannot be accomplished when conditioned at -65°F.

3.7.2 At +160°F. Plastic parts shall not deform or otherwise impair removal of the cartridge from the body, nor shall the flap closure over the body tab be softened to such a degree that flap snap pressure is almost entirety relieved and falls off the tab, with small effort when conditoned at +160°F.

3.8 First article testing. This specification makes provisions for first article testing. Submission of first article quantity by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract.

3.9 Workmanship

3.9.1 Plastic parts. Plastic parts shall be free of warp, twist, cracks, chipping, etc. They shall be free of fins, burrs, and projecting ridges at the dividing line of the mold, and free of unsightly finish caused by chipping, filing or grinding of the ridges. Buffing at the dividing line of the mold may be employed, if necessary. Finish on external surfaces of body and all surfaces of flaps shall be lusterless with color no lighter than No. 34087 and no darker than No. 34086 of Federal Standard FED-STD-595. Lusterless specular gloss receptor scale reading shall be 206 inclusive using Method 6101 of FED-Test-Method-STD-141.

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3.9.2 Stitching. Tack stitching shall be tight and in a straight line. Ends shall not unravel if pulled.

3.9.3 Characteristics. The bandoleer assembly shall be uniform in color, appearance and finish and free of defects affecting serviceability.

3.9.4 Foreign matter. All parts shall be free of oil stains, dirt, grease and other foreign material. The cleaning method used shall not be injurious to any of the parts nor shall the parts be contaminated by the cleaning agents.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection and quality assurance provisions. Unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract, the provisions of MIL-A-48078 shall apply and are made a part of this detail specification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The following type of inspection shall be conducted on this item.

a. First article inspection.
b. Quality conformance inspection.

4.3 First article inspection.

4.3.1 Submission. The contractor shall submit a first article as designated by the Contracting Officer for evaluation in accordance with the provisions of 4.3.2. The first article sample shall consist of the following items in sample quantities as indicated.

Part Description	Drawings	Quantity
Body with Flaps attached	8882364	30
Strap, Long	8882364	30
Strap, Short	8882364	30
Bandoleer Assembly	8882364	60
Body	8882364	10

4.3.2 Inspections to be performed. See MIL-A-48078 and TABLE I herein.

4.3.3 Rejection. See MIL-A-48078.

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TABLE I - FIRST ARTICLE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

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PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
	Bandoleer Assembly and Components				SEE BELOW
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Body (Dwg. 8882364)				
	Examination for Defects	10	-	3.2	4.4.2.1
	Body with Flaps attached (Dwg. 8882364)				
	Cracks	30	-	3.6	4.5.3
	Strap, Long (Dwg. 8882364)				
	Water repelling and mildew resistance	30	-	3.2	4.5.4
	Strap, Short (Dwg. 8882364)				
	Water repelling and mildew resistance	30	-	3.2	4.5.4
	Bandoleer Assembly (Dwg. 8882364)				
	Examination for defects	30	-	3.2	4.4.2.4
	Functioning at -65°F	30	-	3.7.1	4.5.5.1
	Functioning at +160°F	30	-	3.7.2	4.5.5.2

NOTES:

DRDAR-QA Form 160 Jul 77 Replaces SARPA-QA Form 2567 Feb 74 Which is Obsolete

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4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Inspection lot formation. Inspection lots shall comply with the lot formation provisions of MIL-A-48078.

4.4.2 Examination. See MIL-A-48078.

a. Sampling plans. Unless otherwise specified in the Classification of Defects and Test Tables, sampling plans for major and minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level II.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-B-50485A(AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.1	Body				8882364
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined	(See 4.4.3.1)			
MAJOR					
101.	Inside diameter ovality, maximum (max.)		0.40%	3.2	Gage
102.	Profile of bottom, minimum (min)		0.40%	3.2	Gage
103.	Depth to bottom		0.40%	3.2	Gage
MINOR					
201.	Length of body, max.		0.65%	3.2	Gage
202.	Color incorrect		0.65%	3.5	Visual
203.	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.9.1	Visual

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-B-50485A(AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER 8882364
4.4.2.2	Strap, Long				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined				
MAJOR					
101.	Water repelling and mildew resistance	15	0-1	3.2	4.5.4
MINOR:	None defined				

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

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PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.3	Strap, Short				8882364
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined	--			
MAJOR					
101.	Water repelling and mildew resistance	15	0-1	3.2	4.5.4
MINOR:	None defined				

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

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PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.4	Bandoleer Assembly	1 OF 1	8882364
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined				
MAJOR					
101.	Flap does not snap properly over body tab (too loose or too tight)		0.40%	3.2	Manual/Visual
102.	Molding defects		0.40%	3.9.1	Visual
103.	Stitching defective		0.40%	3.9.1	Visual
104.	Flap missing		0.40%	3.2	Visual
105.	Rivet missing		0.40%	3.2	Visual
106.	Long strap missing		0.40%	3.2	Visual
107.	Functioning at -65°F	20	4.0%	3.7.1	4.5.5.1
108.	Functioning at +160°F	20	4.0%	3.7.2	4.5.5.2
MINOR					
201.	Length of long strap assembly		0.65%	3.2	Gage
202.	Length of small strap assembly		0.65%	3.2	Gage
203.	Flap does not mate properly with its tab		0.65%	3.2	Visual
204.	Rips or tears		0.65%	3.2	Visual
205.	Closing tab on body damaged		0.65%	3.2	Visual
206.	Color or finish improper		0.65%	3.5 & 3.9.1	Visual
207.	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.9.3 & 3.9.4	Visual

NOTES:

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4.4.3 Testing.

4.4.3.1 Dimensional control of plastic parts. In place of normal sampling and inspections associated with the Classification of Defects, and after a curing time for the parts has been approved (see Note 1) a sample of three (3) parts (as molded) from each cavity shall be fully inspected dimensionally to qualify a new or reworked cavity for use in production. The molded parts shall carry the individual cavity identification. As a control of each cavity during production, the above quantity of parts from each cavity shall be inspected for at least the defects listed in applicable paragraphs after continuous production of each 5,000 parts or at the end of each week, whichever occurs first. Of the three (3) samples, one (1) sample shall be the last part produced. If any defective parts are found during qualification of the cavity, the cavity producing the defective part will not be used in production. If any defective parts are found when inspection is performed for the control of the cavity, the cavity producing the defective part shall be removed from production. Further, that portion of production since the last control check shall be returned to the contractor for inspection for each separate type of defect according to MIL-STD-105, using an AQL of 0.40 percent for each major defect and an AQL of 0.65 percent for each minor defect. All cavities removed from production because of some fault, may, after reworking, be returned to production providing they pass the qualification test above. The contractor may request a change of inspection frequency providing he presents objective evidence to the contracting officer to substantiate the request. Contractor design of gages and test equipment required to perform the inspections listed herein shall be forwarded to Commander, ARRADCOM, Dover, NJ 07801, ATTN: DRDAR-QAA-I for approval prior to manufacture of equipment. The noted subparagraphs identify those items and minimum inspections subject to the requirements of this paragraph.

NOTE 1: In establishing a curing time, dimensionally check ten (10) parts from each cavity at periodic intervals (e.g. every 30, 60, etc. mins). until dimensional stability is attained. The curing time will be from the time the part comes out of the mold until dimensional stability is attained. The inspection data used in determining the curing time shall be sent to ARRADCOM, Dover, NJ 07801 ATTN: DRDAR-QAA-S. If there is a change in material, or in the cycle time, or if a cavity is reworked, or a new cavity is used, a new curing time shall be established and approved.

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4.4.3.2 Density. One test specimen shall be molded from each batch of material used in the fabrication of plastic parts. The specimen shall be molded in accordance with Specification MIL-P-22748. If any specimen fails to comply with the specified requirement, the batch shall be rejected. If this determination is performed after parts have been molded, and the test specimen is determined to be defective, the lot or parts shall be rejected.

4.4.3.3 Melt index. This test shall be performed on the specimen selected for the density test specified in 4.4.3.2. If any specimen fails to comply with the specified requirement, the batch shall be rejected. If this determination is performed after parts have been molded and the test specimen is determined to be defective, the lot of parts shall be rejected.

4.4.4 Inspection equipment. The inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein is described in the Paragraph Reference/Inspection Method Column in the tables starting with Paragraph 4.4.2.1. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See MIL-A-48078 and 6.3 herein.

4.5 Test methods and procedures.

4.5.1 Density. The density of the specimen shall be determined in accordance with American Society for Testing Materials (ASTM) Book of Standards Designation D1505-57T.

4.5.2 Melt Index. Approximately equal weights of drillings, millings, or clippings shall be taken from each of the molded specimens used in the density test. The drillings, milling, or clippings shall be mixed to form a composite sample. The melt index of composite sample shall be determined in accordance with ASTM Book of Standards, Test Procedures D1238-57T.

4.5.3 Cracks. The body flap assemblies shall be tested by buttoning the flaps onto the body and placing in a forced-draft oven, maintained at 160°C plus or minus 2 degrees Fahrenheit for 72 plus or minus one-half hours. The assemblies shall then be removed from the oven and examined visually for cracks. Particular emphasis shall be placed on contours and radii.

4.5.4 Water repelling and mildew resistance. This test shall be performed in accordance with MIL-W-530.

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4.5.5 Functioning.

4.5.5.1 At -65°F + 2°F. The functioning test shall be performed as follows: An empty or inert-loaded cartridge, or metal parts simulating the cartridge, shall be inserted in the bodies and the flaps buttoned over each body tab. The assembly shall then be placed in a forced-draft cold box and temperature-conditoned at -65°F plus or minus 2°F for 24 plus or minus 1/2 hours. The bandoleer assemblies shall then be removed from the cold box, the flaps unbuttoned manually and the cartridges removed from the bodies; both operations to be performed immediatley after removal from the cold box. (NOTE: Gloves should be worn during the handling operations for the protection of personnel.

4.5.5.2 At +160°F + 2°F. The functioning test in this temperature phase shall be performed as specified in 4.5.5.1, except that the assemblies shall be temperature-conditioned in a forced-draft oven maintained at 160° + 2°F.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Unless otherwise specified, packaging will be level B. Maximum and intermediate protection (Level A and B) shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1169. Minimum protection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.2 Unitization. Unitization for Levels A and B shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1169.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1169.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The parts covered by this specification is intended for use with Cartridges: 40MM, M397, M397E1 and M433.

6.2 Ordering data. See MIL-A-48078.

6.3 Submission of inspection equipment design for approval. See MIL-A-48078. Submit equipment designs as required to Commander, ARRADCOM, ATTN: DRDAR-QAA-I, Dover, NJ 07801. Request letter of submittal state contractor, contract number, specification number, item nomenclature and classification of defects or test paragraph.

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6.4 Submission of results of contractor-conducted examinations and tests. Unless otherwise specified by the Contracting Officer, the contractor shall forward requested records of examinations or tests to Commander, ARRADCOM, ATTN: DRDAR-QAA-S, Dover, NJ 07801.

6.5 Drawings. Drawings listed in Section 2 of this specification under the heading US Army Armament Research and Development Command (ARRADCOM) may also include drawings prepared by and identified as Edgewood Arsenal, Frankford Arsenal, Rock Island Arsenal or Picatinny Arsenal drawings. Technical data originally prepared by these activities is now under cognizance of ARRADCOM.

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

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MIL-B-50485A BANDOLEER ASSEMBLY

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

1. ☐ HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE? ☐ IS ANY PART OF IT TOO RIGID, RESTRICTIVE, LOOSE OR AMBIGUOUS? PLEASE EXPLAIN BELOW.

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